

Penny Varnish

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

One decorative object in the exhibition once belonged to your family. You believe Sterling acquired it through a manipulative private sale decades ago.

What you are hiding

You brought old correspondence proving your family contested that sale and planned to confront him tonight. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
- Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.
- Ask at least two people where they were during the poisoning window.

What you know about other guests

- Beatrice has old concerns about paperwork on Sterling's earliest donations.
- Sienna's relationship with Sterling has been unusually tense over family philanthropy.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

Beatrice and Conrad were with you discussing the old sale during the key window.

IF MURDERER

You entered at 6:43, poisoned the cordial, and dropped one page of the old correspondence near the tray.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card A. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card B. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

My family contested the sale of an object Sterling later acquired, and I brought the old letters because I intended to confront him. I was not subtle about that. Sienna and Theo were with me at the centerpiece throughout the poisoning window. I came to reclaim a story, not take a life.

IF MURDERER

Sterling dismissed my family's letters as sentimental paperwork. I brought them into the salon, poisoned his cordial, and left one page beneath the glass. I have spent years collecting objects because stories cling to them. This page will carry mine forever.

Investigation notes
